Putting AntiFake into practice

A checklist for investigating any false or misleading claim

It is time to practise what we have learned. We can work with a news story, a video, a photograph, a social media post, a piece of data, a WhatsApp message or a claim suggested by an audience.

The aim is not to prove that information is false. It is to investigate it together and go as far as the evidence allows.

PAUSE

☐ What exactly is the claim we want to check?

☐ Do we have the original post, news story, video, image or data?

☐ Can we avoid deciding whether it is true or false before investigating?

LOOK

☐ Who publishes it or makes the claim?

☐ Who is it about?

☐ Does it concern one person, or does it generalise about an entire group?

☐ Does it use words or images that provoke fear, anger or rejection?

☐ Does it construct an “us” and a “them”?

☐ What story is it telling us? What might it be leaving out?

CHECK

☐ Can we find the original source?

☐ Does the person, body or media outlet presented as the source exist?

☐ What is the date of the information?

☐ If there is data, can we find where it comes from?

☐ Do other independent, reliable sources confirm the information?

☐ If there is a photograph or video, does it really correspond to the place, time and situation described?

☐ Do we have enough context to understand the

CHECK

information?

THINK

☐ What do we know now that we did not know at the beginning?

☐ Was important information missing?

☐ Is an individual case being turned into a claim about an entire group?

☐ Does the evidence really support the conclusion presented by the message?

☐ Has our opinion changed after checking the information?

ACT

Now we can ask:

What can we assert on the basis of the evidence we have found?

☐ TRUE: the available sources allow us to confirm the claim.

☐ FALSE: the available evidence contradicts it.

☐ MISLEADING / MISSING CONTEXT: it contains real information, but presents it selectively or out of context.

☐ GENERALISATION: it uses a case or a piece of data to attribute characteristics to an entire group.

ACT

☐ WE CANNOT VERIFY IT: we do not have enough evidence to reach a conclusion.

What do we do now?

☐ We do not share information we have checked and found to be false or misleading.

☐ If we share it to debunk it, we provide the source that allows it to be checked.

☐ If context is missing, we add it.

☐ If it affects a group, we also seek out that group's voices and perspectives.

☐ If we cannot verify it, we say so: “We do not have enough information to know.”

AntiFake does not give us the answer. It gives us a path for finding it.